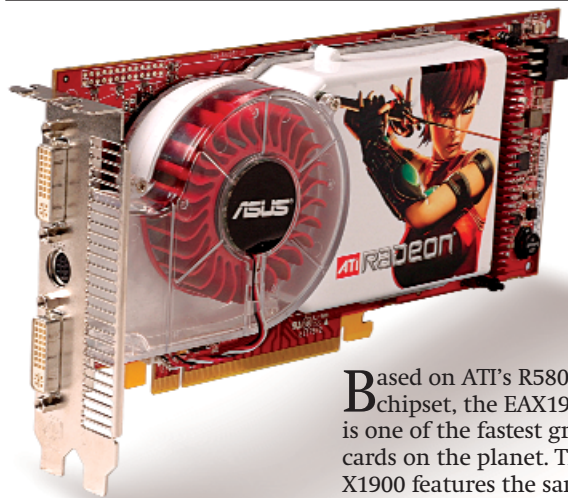




Based on ATI's R580 chipset, the EAX1900XTX is one of the fastest graphics cards on the planet. The X1900 features the same 512-bit ring bus controller of the X1800 series. With the R580, ATI followed up with more pixel crunching power. The core architecture remains the same—the 90 nm 16-pixel pipe design. What ATI did was ramp up the Pixel Shader processors to a massive 48 units. This effectively triples the pixel throughput of the X1900

RATINGS

Performance	★★★★★
Ease of use	★★★★☆
Build quality	★★★★☆
Value for money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★★

Asus EAX1900XTX

Furious 'n' fast

series. The "XTX" signifies a top-of-the-line product, and the Asus EAX1900XTX is clocked at 625 MHz core and 1500 MHz memory speeds.

Asus has used the massive dual-slot stock ATI cooler unit. The fan is totally enclosed, and it's a touch noisy. Hot air is blown out through the second slot of the cooling solution, out the rear of the cabinet. This helps cool the 384 million transistor core, and also 512 megabytes of GDDR3 memory! We saw the temperatures rise to 76 degrees, but with rock solid stability, no complaints here!

We set up the EAX1900XTX on a Socket 939 based 4800+ and fired up F.E.A.R., which saw a little over 50 fps at 1600 x 1200,

with all the eye candy invoked! This card churned out in excess of 12000 in our 3D Mark 05 test, an all-time high in our test labs for a single card.

The EAX1900XTX costs Rs 40,000 plus taxes, but gamers will gladly sell a body part for such a card!

Specifications

ATI Radeon R580 core, 48 Pixel Processors, 8 Vertex Shader units, 650 MHz core, 1.55 GHz memory (512 MB GDDR3), Shader Model 3.0 (Direct X9.0c), Open GL 2.0 compliant

Contact: AsusTek Computer

Phone: 022-40058923

E-mail: media_india@asus.com

Web site: www.asus.com.tw

Price: Rs 40,000

JVC GR-D350AG Camcorder

Gets The Basics Right

This is an inexpensive camcorder suited for first-time users. The package includes the usual bundled components, but no USB cable and video capture software!

This compact camcorder measures only 2.38 x 3.75 x 4.5 inches (WxHxD) and weighs only 400 grams. Features include 1/6-inch 680,000 pixel CCD, 32x optical zoom, and 800x digital hyper-zoom. The LCD screen is 2.5 inches, and the claimed battery life is 80 minutes with the LCD on and 90 minutes using the viewfinder. The camcorder uses mini DV as the recording media.

The GR-D350AG offers many shooting modes. Image modes include sports, snow,

spotlight, and twilight. Night-scope mode makes subjects brighter, but due to the slow shutter speeds, it looks as if it is strobing. You also have effects such as sepia, monotone B&W, classic, and strobe. Also included is the snapshot mode, allowing you to use the camcorder as a digital camera.

As with other JVC camcorders, the GR-D350AG offers the data battery function—showing the

remaining battery and recording time without the need to turn on the camera.

We recorded in SP mode, with digital image stabiliser turned On and wind cut enabled. The 2.5-inch LCD screen is well-suited for outdoor use—it is clear and bright. Colour reproduction in the recording was remarkably good. Indoors, recording quality wasn't as good; the quality was further degraded due to the absence of a flash. We changed the exposure settings, and recording quality improved marginally.

The digital image stabiliser fails after 10x,

so at 32x, images are rather shaky. Another problem is that while zooming in, it does not pause at the point where it switches from optical to digital zoom.

Photo quality leaves much to be desired. Sound quality is good enough. The wind cut function also worked well at all times.

The camera claims to have Webcam functionality using FireWire, but since it did not come with a cable, we could not test this.

Overall, this is a basic camcorder at a decently low price.

Specifications

32x optical zoom, 2.5-inch LCD screen, uses mini DV, shutter speeds 1/50–1/4000, full-auto/manual white balance, approx. weight 430 g, dimensions 56 x 94 x 112 mm

Contact: MCC group

Phone: 011-26102975/77

E-mail: vipin@mcc.co.in

Web site: www.mcc.co.in

Price: Rs 19,990



RATINGS

Performance	★★★★☆
Features	★★★★☆
Build quality	★★★★☆
Value for money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★★